

DOES THIS SECTION
EVEN NEED AN
INTRODUCTION?
FROM COMPUTERS
TO MOBILES, AND
HEADPHONES TO
GPUS, IT'S ALL
HERE...

THIS MONTH IN TECH:
All you need to know
about Intel's new CPU
architecture, followed
by an analysis of how
co-working spaces affect
startups. We show you
how to build an app
without writing a single
line of code and also
how to master Instagram
engagement and Adobe
Rush CC.



Discord Raises \$150M, valuation crosses \$2B

Gaming chat startup discord secured \$150M in the latest round of funding. Discord had recently launched their own games store while offering a revenue split of 90/10 for developers which is a much more lucrative deal than the 70/30 ratio that Steam offers.

<https://dgit.in/Discord2B>

WHAT'S NEW

Facebook building a stablecoin for WhatsApp

Facebook is developing its own cryptocurrency for its WhatsApp platform to enable users to transfer money with each other. India will be the first market for Facebook for this new technology. WhatsApp does allow transferring money in India via the UPI backbone and it's too early to say how this new development will play into the existing system. The cryptocurrency being developed is a stablecoin, a digital currency that will be matched to USD to reduce volatility. The RBI has put a stop to cryptocurrencies in India with the reason being that the current legal framework cannot deal with



digital currencies. It will be interesting to see how Facebook would introduce a cryptocurrency in India without RBI changing its stance.

Facebook's foray into the financial services market was expected since they hired former PayPal president, David Marcus in 2014. WhatsApp has over 200 million users in India and Indians also send the most money home, crossing \$69 billion in 2017.

<https://dgit.in/FbWaCoin>

Apple suffers setback in Qualcomm lawsuit

Apple and Qualcomm have been engaged in multiple lawsuits across multiple countries over their Intellectual Properties. Apple argued that Qualcomm does not have the legal right to increase royalty fees for its technologies. To this effect, Apple sued Qualcomm in three countries, U.S.A., China and Germany. In the U.S., Apple sued Qualcomm for \$1 billion while in China the amount was a modest \$145 million.



Qualcomm won the lawsuit in China and Apple was ordered to stop selling iPhones in China as a result. Apple has contended that it need not comply with the judgement since the subject of the lawsuit pertains to an older

version of iOS. In Germany, Apple was found to be infringing Qualcomm's patents and was ordered to stop sales of their older iPhones there. The ruling only applies to a fraction of all the iPhones that are sold in Germany. In order to enforce the band on sales in Germany, the Munich court placed a condition that Qualcomm would have to post a bond or security deposit of about 668.4 million euros.

<https://dgit.in/iPhonePull>



China ends freeze on game approvals

After a nine-month long freeze in license approvals for video games in China, the government has announced that they've finished reviewing the first batch of games and that licenses will be assigned soon before moving onto the next batch of video games.

<https://dgit.in/GameThaw>



Apple sales fall in India

With Apple smartphones getting more expensive every year, sales for their iPhones have been dropping in India with Apple raking in less than 50% of their estimates. Apple has reportedly reduced production of their phones owing to the drop in sales.

<https://dgit.in/AppleDrop>



GraphQL sees massive adoption

GraphQL, an open-source language developed by Facebook and inspired by their own Facebook Query Language has seen a massive growth in adoption over the past two years, especially among javascript developers. Adoption grew from 5% to 20% in two years.

<https://dgit.in/GraphQL>